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Microsoft

Program Management

BY ABHIMANYU SRIVASTAVA

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Root Cause Analysis

Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).

Initially, 40-45 students were shortlisted based on resume for GD round. In the GD round, they gave a case: **How will you integrate LinkedIn with Microsoft Products.** This round is more individual-based, where you'll be conversing with the interviewers on a regular basis for almost 30 mins and will have to give a 1-minute pitch of your solution at the end. In this round, the major focus is on structure and thinking pattern of the candidates. Please note that you'll have to submit the paper that you use to structure your thoughts, so make sure that whatever you write is legible.

1. **Does work experience matter?**

   Though there were a few shortlists who didn't have IT background, still there was some weightage attached to it in terms of technical questions being asked in the later rounds.

2. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   Round 1 (45 mins): First round started with a few resume-based questions, the focus being on work experience mainly. I had worked on a project on Big Data, so they asked a few questions regarding the project. After that, I was asked how I will identify Java related keywords given a piece of text. The focus was on Machine Learning in this question and how will you identify training set in this.

   After that I was asked that if a B2B product is going to be late, then how you will identify the features to be put first. Be ready to take a decision based on various metrics and customer requirements.

   Finally, I was asked why you want to join Microsoft and then they discussed about Kaizala app. So, be sure to know enough details about Microsoft products.

   Round 2: "You're a PM for data-centre operations which is being used by various start-ups. There is a natural calamity and the data-centre can't operate. What will you do in this situation? What will you do if there's no backup for the last few days?"

Select any Microsoft product, identify a problem in it and suggest ways to resolve the problem. Make sure that the problem that you are trying to solve in this round is not very small.

Round 3: How will you design a tech-based product for kids so that they are used to Microsoft products and will keep on using it when they grow up? The product could have been based on an existing Microsoft product/technology or an entirely new product. In this question, I had to identify the stakeholders – kids (what age group), parents, teachers etc. who will be influencing the use of product. Based on their needs I had to come up with a set of features to be offered and then focus on technology which can enable these features. Further we also discussed monetization of the product.

3. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Why Microsoft?
   Those who didn't have relevant work experience or internship were also asked why they wanted to go for PM role.

4. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Their GD round and case problems are focused on Microsoft products, so make sure that you've at least some idea about all the major products.
   - You should know how to solve a product-design questions. Practice them thoroughly before the interviews.
   - Be thorough with latest technologies. If you mention any of them in the interview, the interviewers will expect you to know about it thoroughly. It also gives you some edge over others.

Product Management

BY ARSHDEEP SINGH

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, Product Execution

Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).

First Round: Case GD (for all the shortlisted candidates) – They gave a case: How **will you integrate LinkedIn with Microsoft Products**. You will get 30 min for solving this. In between the interviewers will come to you and ask about your approach. After 30 min everyone must give a 1 min pitch of their solution. If you give a structured pitch (briefing all the steps you considered for solving this), I think your chances of getting selected increase.

After this I had 3 rounds of interviews involving technical questions, product questions, Guesstimates, general CV questions and questions related to latest tech news.

1. **Does work experience matter?**

Yes, I think in laterals, work experience matters. But even if you don't have IT background, you may get a shortlist (there were people without any IT background in our batch who cleared 2 rounds of interviews)

2. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

Round 1: I was asked to give ideas for monetization of **WhatsApp.** I suggested some ideas, and then he asked me to do a **guesstimate** of the revenue which will be generated through my ideas. Then I was asked to do a **cost-benefit analysis** of server space utilized to run WhatsApp vs revenue generated through my guesstimate.

He also asked me how peer to peer messaging works (this question is only relevant for those who have IT background). He was asking about Client Server and P2P model. So, be prepared to get 1 or 2 questions like this.

Round 2: How will you detect fake news on **Facebook**? Give your approach and suggest ideas to prevent it. Then I was asked to explain the economics behind **surge pricing** of Uber and derive formulae for it. Please read Microeconomics (Demand and Supply curve) or study solution for this problem on the internet. The surge pricing is a standard problem asked everywhere in PM interviews.

Round 3: Why did Ola acquire Foodpanda? In this I followed an approach given in case book written by Issac Jojey (for consult interviews). Please refer to M&A section of the casebook.

3. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**

   Why PM?
   Why Microsoft?
   Why you did internship in Consulting (if you didn't do intern in PM role, you should prepare for this question)

4. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - First of all, you should read **Crack the Interview for Program managers**. This book is very comprehensive. So, you should pick and choose what to study and what not to study
   - Practice Product questions (Design a product, favourite product, product pricing models, e-commerce revenue models)
   - Guesstimates
   - Read Case interviews by Issac Jojey (this is helpful in structuring your thoughts, may not be directly applicable for PM interviews)
   - Be in touch with latest Tech events
   - If you have time revise DS1, DS2, Marketing Management and Microeconomics

Product Management

BY TULASI VIJAY KUMAR THULLURU

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy, System Design

1 **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
GD + Four rounds of case interviews

2 **Does work experience matter?**
Yes, for every PM role work experience matters. Even if you don't have work ex, you should be aware of the tech products you use on a day to day basis.

3 **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
Round 1: Case interview: You are the PM at Youtube. How will you design an algorithm for suggesting recommended videos?
Round 2: Case interview: How do you apply surge price factors in Ola/Uber.
Round 3: *Case interview*: You are an engineering manager and developing a Learning Management System. What functionalities would you have in the Minimum Viable Product? How would you select colleges to pitch your idea?
Round 4: I was asked if you are in New York interviewing for a role of Private Equity Manager. You are buying a hotel. How would you evaluate the Hotel?

4 **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
Questions about academic record.

Flipkart

Product Management

BY ABHIMANYU SRIVASTAVA

PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy, App Critique, Behavioral

Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).

All the applicants were provided a case and had to submit a presentation for the same. After that, around 25 students were shortlisted for interviews. The topic of the case was – "Choose a product or product feature that you use or love and then suggest ways to improve it. How would you measure and know if the product or feature has improved?"

Once shortlisted after this, I went through 5 rounds of interviews which focused on case-solving, product-strategy questions, technical questions and finally a few resume-based and HR questions.

1. **Does work experience matter?**

I think work ex plays a small part in initial shortlist. But since they have a technical round, it's good to have tech knowledge. I mean you won't be able to crack it if you haven't done any coding in life.

2. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

Round 1 (30-45 mins): First round started with tell me about yourself followed by a case-based question – *The site-wide conversion for EBay India has decreased lately. What might be the reasons?* On approaching the problem through customer purchase funnel, I identified the problem in payment gateway. Then they said that the payment gateway is provided by a 3rd party and asked for a resolution that can be implemented in a short period of time.

Round 2 (1 hour): This round focused on product strategy questions in which I was asked to **develop a marketplace for refurbished or second-hand products.** The discussion was focused on identifying the product, market (B2B, B2C or C2C) and associated problems with each of these (seller verification etc.), pricing strategy, features to be present, whether it should be part of Flipkart or a separate website, and finally look and feel of the website. My advice would be to start by looking at problems that customer will face while buying such a product and how they can be solved.

Round 3 (1 hour): Initial discussion in this round was on – "What is your favourite app? What do you like the most about it? What metrics would you use to track its performance?"

After that, they gave another site-wide conversion issue. Using the same customer purchase funnel' approach, the problem was identified to be dropping of customers after search. The reason was identified to be change in product types due to old vendors moving out and new vendors coming in. Finally they asked to suggest a few ways to resolve the issue.

Round 4 (1 hour): This round mainly focused on technical questions. I was asked to select an app and explain how to design it with exact features. Then they asked how to divide the work in a team of 4/5 people. Apart from that, they also asked about frontend-backend integration for login and verification, and how relational databases can be used. Since I am not from a Computer Science background, the interviewer helped a little bit here by telling that the work should be divided in frontend and backend work.

Round 5 (45 mins): The round started with resume-based questions and a few generic HR questions like 'Tell me about yourself' etc. After that they asked to suggest a category that Flipkart should enter. I jumped into the solution directly, but they wanted me to take a structured approach, starting with their capabilities and the right market for their capabilities, analysing them, identify a solution and then find a few challenges that you might face.

3. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Tell me about yourself, Why Flipkart

4. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Consulting case preparation will help a lot to effectively approach the case-solving questions.
   - Flipkart is obsessed with customers, so always keep them in mind before answering any question.
   - Read about company and its products thoroughly and you should be aware of latest happenings in the company.

Product Management

BY TULASI VIJAY KUMAR THULLURU

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Product Strategy

Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).

Case submission and 5 rounds of interview. Case submission was about one product that you use on a regular basis and one feature that you don't like in it. How will you improve it? Shortlist was based on the case.

1. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, for every PM role work experience matters. Even you don't have work ex you should be aware of the tech products you use on a day to day basis.

2. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Round 1: They asked me how to design a spice rack for the blind. The interview was about my work experience. They didn't ask anything about the case which we submitted. I did my internship in Amazon, so I was asked why Flipkart and not Amazon?
   Round 2: *Case interview* - You are the Product Manager of Swiggy. If you want to add table booking system how would you do it. It was a 1 and a half an hour interview.
   Round 3: *Case interview* - You are the Product Manager at Ola. You are designing a cab system. How will you implement surge pricing?
   Round 4: *Engineering Round* - Taken by a software engineer manager. He will look for a PM who can converse well will the engineers. He asked me what the broad blocks in the system of Uber are and how these interact with one another.
   There was elimination after every round

3. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Fifth round is an HR round

Sprinklr

Product Management

BY ABHIMANYU SRIVASTAVA

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Behavioral

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**

   Resume based shortlist of 15-20 students. One day before the interviews, a case was given to the applicants. The case was to make a strategy for a retail bank on how to use a social media management suite software provided by your company.

   After this, there were 2 rounds of interviews with focus on the case, digital marketing strategy and a few HR questions.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Work experience doesn't matter as lot of shortlisted people were not from technical background.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Round 1: Tell me about yourself followed by discussion of solution to the case.
   Round 2: There was one more case-based question in which I had to design a digital marketing strategy for a political party using Sprinklr's software. They also asked a few generic HR questions.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Tell me about yourself.
   Having worked in large organizations, how will you fit into the start-up culture at Sprinklr?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Practice case-solving thoroughly as the interviews consisted mainly of this only. It's necessary to have a structured approach to solve the cases.
   - Be aware about the digital marketing software provided by Sprinklr.

Product Management

BY TULASI VIJAY KUMAR THULLURU

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Case submission-based shortlist.
2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Relevant experience in Prod Man or Tech experience. And high CGPA also matters.
3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Case submission questions: Your approach, metrics, how would you monetize it, competitive benchmarking, product roadmap.
   Questions about my Work Experience. Different things you would consider while selecting clients for Sprinklr. Name 10 clients in 10 minutes.

Gulf Talent

Product Management (Sr. Business Analyst)

BY ABHIMANYU SRIVASTAVA

PM Topics Covered: Product Design, Metrics

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   First there was a resume-based shortlisting of around 25 students. After that, there was a GD round in a group of 6. The topic of our group was to develop a product for wedding market that leads to low cost without losing the radiance of the wedding. 8 people were further shortlisted for interviews.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   No, it doesn't

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   Round 1 (45 mins): "Uber has a new feature to tip the drivers. What are the metrics that you'll use to check if the feature is performing well?" Most of the round was focused around this question. Apart from that, there were a few generic HR questions.
   Round 2: This round was taken by the MD of the company and focused on a few generic HR questions like "Why this company?" and resume-based questions.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Why this company?
   Tell me about yourself
   Have you worked under a demanding manager and how did you manage?
   What is the one thing that will demotivate you from working?

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Prepare for GDs well. Out of the 4 groups, 5 were selected from a single group and 1 each from the other 3 groups. So, make sure that the group discussion stays on track.
   - Case preparation – Practice solving tech-based cases.

Product Management

BY TULASI VIJAY KUMAR THULLURU

PM Topics Covered: Root Cause Analysis

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Two rounds + HR Round
2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, for every PM role work experience matters.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   They are not looking for very ambitious people.
   Round 1: Work Experience. One significant achievement from your resume. Projects you have worked for. Why did you not go for exchange? More personal experiences. Guestimate: How will you calculate the number of hair on a Dog?
   Round 2: Case interview: You are the PM at Swiggy. It is experiencing a decline in sales. What different things will you look at. You have to use a structured approach.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Covered in 1st round.

Deloitte

Tech Strategy and Transformation

BY CHANDRIMA PAUL

PM Topics Covered: Behavioral

Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc).

The company came for 2 roles – Tech Strategy (TST), and Strategy & Operations. While for S&O, there were video interviews with 3-4 questions (time limit – 2 mins each), for TST role, candidates were directly shortlisted based on CV. There was no GD for either of the roles.

Around 30-35 students were shortlisted for TST, who were assigned a buddy each. The shortlisting and assigning of buddy were done around 4 days before the interview. The buddies helped with the preparation material and provided guidance for tech-based cases. A day before the interviews, Deloitte also conducted a workshop for tech-based cases. The workshop was interactive, and everyone was provided a sheet with their names. As the people present in the workshop were also there during the interviews, participation in the workshop also played a role in the selection process. In the end, the company selected 5 people from the campus for TST role.

1. **Does work experience matter?**
   All the students shortlisted for TST role had a tech background.
2. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   a. Round 1: Interview round 1 was mainly focused on introduction and CV-based questions. Most of the students were also asked to solve guesstimates, but not everyone. This round was also an elimination round, but only a few were eliminated.
   b. Round 2: This round was a major elimination round and had a tech-based case. In my case, the case was related to IT M&A. The approach to solve tech-based cases was also informed in the workshop held and it really helped in this round. I was directly selected after the round, but others went through a 3rd round of interview too.
   c. Round 3: This was a partner round and mainly focused on HR questions only. The objective of this round was to check the cultural fit of interviewees with the company. The elimination was there only if the round went very bad, otherwise most were selected.
3. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   To test the cultural fit of interviewees with the company.
4. **How do you recommend a pgp2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   You should be thorough with what's written in your resumes and should practice solving guesstimates as it was there for most in the first round. For tech-based cases, both – material (frameworks and approach) and guidance, were provided by the assigned buddy. But the buddies were assigned only 4 days before the interviews, so preparing for such

cases in advance will be helpful. A workshop was also conducted by the company a day before the interviews which was focused on solving tech-based cases only.

Tech Strategy andTransformation

BY RAGHUNANDHAN V

PM Topics Covered: Product Strategy, Behavioral

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).**
   Resume shortlisting of 35-40 students which is followed by a workshop one day prior to the interviews. Buddies are also assigned to the shortlisted candidates who help with the preparation material and provide guidance for tech-based cases. The workshop is for helping with the approach to solve tech-based cases, and is interactive. Everyone was provided with a sheet with their names, and since the people in workshop were also present during the interviews, the participation in the workshop also played a role in the selection process. The number of interview rounds varied from 2 to 3 for different candidates.

2. **Does work experience matter?**

   Yes, all the shortlisted students had a tech background.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   Round 1 (15-20 mins): Round 1 mainly focused on resume-based questions and the latest technical trends. I wasn't asked any guesstimate in the round, but most of the others had to solve a guesstimate too.
   Round 2 (30+ mins): A major elimination round and had a tech-based case. I got a live case started with IT M&A problem, then went to ERP and finally to increased cost issues. Tech-based cases have a different approach and it's essential to be attentive in the workshop as it really helps structure our thoughts in the right way.
   Round 3: Round 3 was a partner round and mainly to test the fit of the candidates with the company. It focused mainly on HR questions and resume-based questions.

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Generic questions to test the fit of the candidates with the company.

5. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - Be thorough with your resume, what have you worked on and what is the future in it.
   - Prepare well for tech-based cases. The buddies provided the materials and helped with the preparation, but they were assigned only a few days before interviews. So, it's better to be prepared well in advance.
   - If you've used any software or framework, make sure that you know when to use them and what type of projects are they suitable for.

Tech Strategy andTransformation

BY BEAUTY BARMAN

PM Topics Covered: Product Execution

Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc.).

There are 3 rounds of interview.

1st: a Guesstimate round which is different for different panels. I was asked to find the no of libraries because of my interest in books. Also, some general questions on my work experience.

2nd: A case round which evolved out of my resume and they test you on the technicalities and your ability to link new technologies and metrics to measure them.

3rd: This is a Partner Round where I was just asked why a career in Technology consulting and why Deloitte

1. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, Very much! It is driven by relevant work experience in fact.
   I had worked in Agile and I was asked no of questions as where and why is Agile better. What metrics I would use to measure its efficacy, when will I recommend to client to go agile etc.
2. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**

   Know your resume thoroughly. Questions can spring from everywhere. Bring in Anecdotes and tie them with Deloitte's philosophy.
3. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   I wasn't asked any.

4. **How do you recommend a PGP2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Go through guesstimates and read technology news (loads of APPs available)
   Know your work experience and don't bluff. Being yourself always helps.

Go Jek

Product Management

BY TULASI VIJAY KUMAR THULLURU

PM Topics Covered: Product Design

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc).**
   Case submission + Four rounds interview. Quality of case submission matters for shortlist.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Round 1: Case submission based: Monetization, competitive benchmarking, improving the features etc.
   Round 2: 2 hours interview. One product that you use. Why do you like it? One feature you don't like and how will you improve it. What new features will you add? And how will you go about it. They had a role play there where one of the interviewer became the customer and I had to convince the other one about the feature. It was a stress interview. Another question was one app that you don't like. They asked me if I have taken any statistics subject. I said DS and DS 2. They asked me to explain how linear regression to a 6th grader. Break it down, ask questions and follow a structured approach.
   Round 3: It was an HR round. What kind of work excites you. Why didn't you join Amazon? etc

4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   What kind of work excites you. Why didn't you join Amazon? etc.

United Health Group

Analytics Manager

BY TULASI VIJAY KUMAR THULLURU

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc).**
   Three rounds. They came for two roles – Manager(Analytics) and Business Analyst

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, they will look at your work experience.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Round 1: It was with a person from IIM C. They asked about academic record. He asked about work experience. Then he asked you are meeting a CEO for 5 minutes you have to tell him what it takes to digitalize the company. Internship experience.
   Round 2: With two directors, stress interviews. What kind of work did you do with Amazon. Analytics focused work ex.
   Case: Amazon is seeing a decline in sales. How will you go about it? Last month there was an update in the process. You have to look where did the update happen in the value chain.
   Round 3: HR round. Fit interview. Location constraints, significant achievements in work ex. One thing that you are proud of doing at IIM B. One thing that you don't like about IIMB. Are you an individual contributor?
4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Third round
5. **How do you recommend a pgp2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   Detail oriented, structure oriented
   Energetic throughout the process
   Digitalization: talk about cost savings, the outreach you will have with customers, revenue increase with digitalization, customer satisfaction.
   When you are asking question to the interviewer use it to your advantage. Express your interest in the company by showing what you have studied about them and then ask them the questions.

Accenture

Tech Consulting

BY RAVIRAJ SINDHANI

1. **Describe the steps in the process i.e. no of interview rounds, GD, pre-process requirements (LOI, case submission etc).**
   No GD, only resume submission and two rounds of interview. One Technical and One HR. But in both the interviews they asked both technical and HR questions.

2. **Does work experience matter?**
   Yes, if you have relevant work experience, then it is an added advantage. They were interested in someone who is keen to learn platform and packages. The work is cloud, AWS, AI and IOT.

3. **What kind of questions were asked? What is the general area of focus during the interviews?**
   Real life cased based question or situational questions
   Question about past work experience (Both work and Internship)
   Why tech Consulting?
   Why Accenture?
4. **What kind of HR questions were asked?**
   Why Consulting?
   Are you open to learning?
   How are you a perfect fit for the company?
5. **How do you recommend a pgp2 should structure his preparation? Resources/ tools that can help aid in preparation?**
   - How to crack PM Interview.
   - If it's a tech interview mostly answer all the questions based on 3 parameters: People, Process and Tech (Infrastructure and Application).
   - Case based preparation would help in structuring the thought process.

   Tech Interview Questions:
   - How will you design a product X for Y kind of people?
   - How will you enhance a product X for Y kind of people?